

Internal Mirror

Thought · Feeling · Body

A between-session tool for noticing what runs under the symptom. Ten short entries — one each time something shifts in your mood, your gut, or your body. Nothing here is scored. You are gathering pattern, not evidence against yourself.

NAME

CLINICIAN

PERIOD COVERED

— HOW TO USE IT

Curiously notice first. Then *acknowledge, validate, respond*.

00

Curiously notice

Turn towards it without deciding what it means.
"Something just changed — what is it?"

01

Acknowledge

Name it plainly, out loud or on paper.
"My gut is tight and I'm telling myself I'll be caught out."

02

Validate

Make sense of it.
"Given the last two years, of course my body reads this as risk."

03

Respond

One deliberate move, small enough to actually do. Not a fix — a next step.

Reacting skips straight from noticing to doing. Acknowledging and validating are the two steps that keep the response yours rather than the tunnel's.

The ten entries

Bring the completed sheet to your next appointment. Partial entries are still useful.

O1 ENTRY

DATE

DISTRESS

/ 10

WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT I NOTICED

THE STORY I AM TELLING MYSELF

THE FEELING

WHERE I FEEL IT IN MY BODY

- ☐ Chest ☐ Stomach / gut ☐ Shoulders / neck
☐ Throat ☐ Head ☐ Arms / legs ☐ Other

what it feels like

ACKNOWLEDGE

VALIDATE

RESPOND

O2 ENTRY

DATE

DISTRESS

/ 10

WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT I NOTICED

THE STORY I AM TELLING MYSELF

THE FEELING

WHERE I FEEL IT IN MY BODY

- ☐ Chest ☐ Stomach / gut ☐ Shoulders / neck
☐ Throat ☐ Head ☐ Arms / legs ☐ Other

what it feels like

ACKNOWLEDGE

VALIDATE

RESPOND

03 ENTRY

DATE

DISTRESS

/ 10

WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT I NOTICED

THE STORY I AM TELLING MYSELF

THE FEELING

WHERE I FEEL IT IN MY BODY

- ☐ Chest ☐ Stomach / gut ☐ Shoulders / neck
☐ Throat ☐ Head ☐ Arms / legs ☐ Other

what it feels like

ACKNOWLEDGE

VALIDATE

RESPOND

04 ENTRY

DATE

DISTRESS

/ 10

WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT I NOTICED

THE STORY I AM TELLING MYSELF

THE FEELING

WHERE I FEEL IT IN MY BODY

- ☐ Chest ☐ Stomach / gut ☐ Shoulders / neck
☐ Throat ☐ Head ☐ Arms / legs ☐ Other

what it feels like

ACKNOWLEDGE

VALIDATE

RESPOND

05 ENTRY

DATE

DISTRESS

/ 10

WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT I NOTICED

THE STORY I AM TELLING MYSELF

THE FEELING

WHERE I FEEL IT IN MY BODY

- ☐ Chest ☐ Stomach / gut ☐ Shoulders / neck
☐ Throat ☐ Head ☐ Arms / legs ☐ Other

what it feels like

ACKNOWLEDGE

VALIDATE

RESPOND

06 ENTRY

DATE

DISTRESS

/ 10

WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT I NOTICED

THE STORY I AM TELLING MYSELF

THE FEELING

WHERE I FEEL IT IN MY BODY

- ☐ Chest ☐ Stomach / gut ☐ Shoulders / neck
☐ Throat ☐ Head ☐ Arms / legs ☐ Other

what it feels like

ACKNOWLEDGE

VALIDATE

RESPOND

07 ENTRY

DATE

DISTRESS

/ 10

WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT I NOTICED

THE STORY I AM TELLING MYSELF

THE FEELING

WHERE I FEEL IT IN MY BODY

- ☐ Chest ☐ Stomach / gut ☐ Shoulders / neck
☐ Throat ☐ Head ☐ Arms / legs ☐ Other

what it feels like

ACKNOWLEDGE

VALIDATE

RESPOND

08 ENTRY

DATE

DISTRESS

/ 10

WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT I NOTICED

THE STORY I AM TELLING MYSELF

THE FEELING

WHERE I FEEL IT IN MY BODY

- ☐ Chest ☐ Stomach / gut ☐ Shoulders / neck
☐ Throat ☐ Head ☐ Arms / legs ☐ Other

what it feels like

ACKNOWLEDGE

VALIDATE

RESPOND

09 ENTRY

DATE

DISTRESS

/ 10

WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT I NOTICED

THE STORY I AM TELLING MYSELF

THE FEELING

WHERE I FEEL IT IN MY BODY

- ☐ Chest ☐ Stomach / gut ☐ Shoulders / neck
☐ Throat ☐ Head ☐ Arms / legs ☐ Other

what it feels like

ACKNOWLEDGE

VALIDATE

RESPOND

10 ENTRY

DATE

DISTRESS

/ 10

WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT I NOTICED

THE STORY I AM TELLING MYSELF

THE FEELING

WHERE I FEEL IT IN MY BODY

- ☐ Chest ☐ Stomach / gut ☐ Shoulders / neck
☐ Throat ☐ Head ☐ Arms / legs ☐ Other

what it feels like

ACKNOWLEDGE

VALIDATE

RESPOND

— LOOKING BACK ACROSS THE TEN

THE STORY THAT REPEATS

WHERE MY BODY SPEAKS FIRST

THE RESPONSE THAT HELPED MOST

TO BRING TO MY NEXT APPOINTMENT

This is a reflective tool, not a clinical measure. The distress ratings track your own sense of load over time — they are not a score of how you are doing.